GenAI Visibility Playbook

How to Make Your Content Visible in AI Search — A Practical Guide for Marketing Teams

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01 How AI Search Works

When someone asks ChatGPT, Perplexity, or similar tools a question, the AI doesn't just "know" the answer. It runs a structured process to find, evaluate, and assemble content from across the web. Your content either makes it into that answer — or it doesn't.

The 8-Step AI Answer Pipeline

Example query: "Can I still hear naturally after getting a cochlear implant?"

#	Stage	What Happens
1	**Query**	A user asks a question — about cochlear implants, hearing preservation, rehab, or any topic we cover.
2	**Web Scan**	The AI searches the web in real time and collects pages that could contain relevant answers.
3	**Content Eval**	It evaluates each page for clarity, relevance, and whether the content actually answers the question.
4	**Authority Check**	It assesses source credibility — who published it, whether other trusted sites reference it, whether expertise is visible.
5	**Evidence Extract**	It pulls out specific passages, facts, and statements that are clear enough to use in an answer.
6	**Citation Rank**	Based on combined credibility and evidence quality, it ranks which sources get cited — and which get left out.
7	**Answer Build**	It assembles a single, coherent answer by combining and summarising the best-ranked evidence.
8	**Output**	The user sees the final answer, often with source links. Your content is either in there or it isn't.

Stages 3–6 are where you win or lose. This guide covers what you can do to pass all four.

02 Start With the Questions Your Audience Asks

GEO only works when you know which questions patients, CI candidates, and professionals are typing into AI tools. Without a defined set of target queries, optimisation has no direction. These questions are the foundation — every content decision flows from them.

Audience	Example Query	Query Type
CI Candidate	*Can I still hear naturally after getting a cochlear implant?*	Concern / Risk
CI Candidate	*What is the difference between a hearing aid and a cochlear implant?*	Comparison
Patient	*How long does cochlear implant rehab take?*	Practical / Planning
Patient	*What can I expect in the first weeks after CI activation?*	Experience / Timeline
Professional	*What does current evidence say about hearing preservation with CI?*	Clinical Evidence
Professional	*Which electrode design factors affect preservation outcomes?*	Technical / Product

The target query set is defined as part of the overarching marketing strategy and serves as the foundation for all content work that follows.

03 Quick Wins — If You Read Nothing Else, Do These

The table below maps the four pillars of GenAI visibility to the highest-impact actions. Each action is explained in detail on the following pages.

Pillar	Action	CI Example
What You Write	Lead every page with a direct answer (40–70 words) before any brand messaging	*"A cochlear implant can reduce or eliminate some remaining natural hearing, but preservation is possible in many patients."*
What You Write	Make key claims quotable: self-contained, evidence-backed, short enough to extract	*"Hearing preservation after CI is possible, but not guaranteed. Published evidence should be interpreted together with individual clinical factors."*
What You Write	Put study findings in page text — not only in PDFs or footnotes	*Summarise key publication findings in plain language directly on the topic page*
How You Organise	Use a standard page pattern: H1 question → direct answer → key facts → evidence → FAQ	*Page title: "Can cochlear implants affect natural hearing?" followed by answer, facts box, body, FAQ*
How You Organise	Add FAQ blocks covering sub-questions the AI generates (query fanout) and decision-support content	*"Questions to ask your implant team" section on hearing preservation pages*
Technical	Write meta descriptions that preview the answer ("content spoilers")	*Meta: "A CI can affect residual hearing, but preservation is possible. Learn what influences outcomes."*
Technical	Ensure AI crawlers are not blocked (robots.txt, LLMs.txt)	*Check that OAI-SearchBot and other AI crawlers can access key pages*
Credibility	Build third-party mentions — Wikipedia, clinical partners, professional forums	*Ensure neutral CI-related Wikipedia entries exist and reference published evidence*
Credibility	Show authorship, credentials, and review dates on every medical page	*"Written by [name], reviewed by [clinician, role]. Last reviewed: [date]."*

04 Pillar 1 — What You Write

Answer first, brand second

- Lead every priority page with a direct, balanced answer to the user's question (40–70 words).
- Do not open with company history, device descriptions, or brand messaging.
- The opening paragraph must be independently understandable — an AI should be able to extract it without needing the rest of the page.

✗ Before	Our company has been a leader in hearing implant technology for over 30 years. Our cochlear implant system uses advanced electrode design to...
✓ After	A cochlear implant can reduce or eliminate some remaining natural hearing in the implanted ear, but preservation is possible in many patients. Outcomes vary by baseline hearing, anatomy, surgical approach, and electrode choice.

Make claims quotable

- Write key statements as short, self-contained sentences backed by evidence.
- Formula: **Claim → qualifier → evidence cue → practical meaning.**
- Include 2–4 inline citations, 1 expert quote, and 1–2 statistics per priority page.
- Each priority statement should make sense without the surrounding paragraph.

Put evidence in the page, not just in PDFs

- Study findings, statistics, and expert interpretation must appear in the HTML body text.
- Summarise publications in plain language on the page itself — do not rely on download links alone.
- Place key data points in headings or the first 200 characters of a section.

Write clearly and precisely

- Use plain but accurate medical language. Short sentences. Explicit qualifiers.
- Avoid: corporate introductions, vague promotional claims, jargon in the first screen, long blocks without headings.

Make trust and freshness visible

- Show on every priority page: author, medical reviewer + credentials, review date, source list.
- Show: original publish date, last medical review date, last update date.
- When guidance changes, update the main answer — not only the footer.
- Integrate temporal markers in text (e.g. "As of 2026, current evidence suggests...").

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05 Pillar 2 — How You Organise Your Pages

Standard page pattern

- H1 as a real question or precise topic (not a brand slogan)
- 40–70 word direct answer immediately below the H1
- Key facts box with 3–5 points
- Main body in question-led H2/H3 sections ("What is...?", "How does...?")
- Evidence block with studies, quotes, statistics
- FAQ block addressing related sub-questions
- Author / reviewer / date section
- Next-step internal links

FAQ and decision-support modules

When a user asks a main question, the AI doesn't just search for that exact question. It generates a set of related sub-questions to build a complete answer (an LLM search mechanic called **query**

fanout). If your page already addresses those sub-questions — through an FAQ block — you cover more angles the AI is looking for and are significantly more likely to be cited.

Example: sub-questions generated from a single user query

Core question: *"Can a cochlear implant affect my natural hearing?"*

Sub-questions the AI also looks to answer:

→ Does this happen to everyone?
→ What factors influence the outcome?
→ Can hearing be preserved during surgery?
→ What should I ask my surgeon about this?
→ How does electrode design affect preservation?

Your FAQ block should cover these angles. Each sub-question is an opportunity to be cited.

- Add topic-level FAQ blocks to every priority page, covering the sub-questions the AI is likely to generate.
- Include comparison content where appropriate (e.g. CI vs. hearing aid).
- Add "questions to ask your implant team" guidance sections.
- Include glossary links for technical terms.

Internal linking + publication integration

- Link from each priority page to: glossary, evidence summaries, related FAQs, rehab/aftercare content.
- Link to product pages only after informational intent is satisfied.
- For key publications: create an HTML summary with plain-language findings, patient meaning, clinician meaning, 3–5 key takeaways, and limitations.

06 Pillar 3 — Technical Foundations

Metadata & URLs

- Page titles should describe the content precisely — use the target question where possible.
- Meta descriptions should preview the answer (“content spoilers”), not tease it.
- URLs should be short, keyword-rich, and readable.

✗ Before	URL: /products/hearing/page-283746 Meta: Learn more about our innovative hearing solutions.
✓ After	URL: /hearing-preservation/cochlear-implant-natural-hearing Meta: A CI can affect residual hearing, but preservation is possible. Learn what factors influence outcomes.

Schema markup

- Implement JSON-LD structured data to help AI systems understand your page content.
- Priority schema types: Article, FAQPage, Organization, Product (where relevant), BreadcrumbList.
- Only use schema that matches visible page content — do not add FAQ schema without a visible FAQ.

Crawling & indexing

- Check that robots.txt allows AI crawlers: OAI-SearchBot, ClaudeBot, PerplexityBot.
- Implement LLMs.txt (see llmstxt.org) to guide AI crawlers to your most important pages.
- Ensure key answer content is in visible HTML — not hidden behind JavaScript rendering.
- Ensure snippets and indexing are not blocked by meta tags or CDN/WAF settings.

Making multimedia machine-readable

- Add transcripts to all videos.
- Use descriptive alt text on images (not “image1.jpg” but “diagram showing cochlear implant electrode placement”).
- Add a short HTML summary paragraph below every embedded video.
- Use meaningful file names for all media assets.

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07 Pillar 4 — Building Credibility Beyond Your Website

Wikipedia

- Ensure neutral, fact-based Wikipedia entries exist for relevant topics (cochlear implants, hearing preservation, related conditions).
- All claims must be backed by reliable third-party sources (peer-reviewed publications, regulatory guidance).
- Verify notability: independent mentions in media, studies, and industry publications are required.

Reddit & professional communities

- Participate authentically in relevant communities (hearing loss, CI user groups, audiology forums).
- Share genuinely useful content: case studies, educational material, research summaries.
- Consider AMA (Ask Me Anything) sessions with clinical experts.

Partner & clinician mentions

- Work with hospital partners and audiologists to create content that references your brand in credible clinical contexts.
- Support co-authored educational materials and clinic pages.

Earned media & thought leadership

- Secure references in third-party publications, expert roundups, and industry overviews.
- Ensure consistent entity naming and profiles across all external platforms.

Healthcare guardrail: All external authority building must be conservative and credible. No community spam, no review manipulation, no low-quality placements. In healthcare, trust is earned slowly and lost instantly.

08 Page-Level Checklist

Run through this before publishing or updating any priority page.

Pillar	Check	✓
Content	Page opens with a direct answer (40–70 words), not brand messaging	☐
Content	Key claims are self-contained, evidence-backed, and quotable	☐
Content	Study findings and statistics appear in the HTML body text	☐
Content	Language is plain, precise, and medically responsible	☐
Content	Author, reviewer, credentials, and review date are visible	☐
Content	Publish date and last-update date are shown	☐
Structure	H1 is a real question or precise topic	☐
Structure	Page follows the standard pattern: answer → facts → body → evidence → FAQ	☐
Structure	FAQ block addresses related sub-questions (query fanout)	☐
Structure	Internal links connect to glossary, evidence, FAQs, and next steps	☐
Technical	Meta description previews the answer	☐
Technical	URL is short, readable, and keyword-rich	☐
Technical	AI crawlers are not blocked	☐
Technical	Videos have transcripts; images have descriptive alt text	☐
Credibility	Content is referenced or referenceable by third-party sources	☐
Credibility	Related Wikipedia entries are accurate and well-sourced	☐

09 Common Mistakes to Avoid

Don’t	Do Instead
Open pages with brand history or corporate messaging	Lead with a direct, balanced answer to the user’s question
Hide study data and evidence in PDFs or footnotes only	Summarise key findings in plain language in the HTML body
Use vague promotional language (“industry-leading”, “innovative solution”)	Make specific, evidence-backed claims that an AI can extract and cite
Leave pages without visible authorship or review dates	Show who wrote it, who reviewed it, and when — on every medical page
Block AI crawlers unknowingly via robots.txt or CDN settings	Explicitly allow OAI-SearchBot, ClaudeBot, PerplexityBot in robots.txt
Write long paragraphs without headings or structure	Use question-led H2/H3 sections, short paragraphs, key facts boxes
Rely on your homepage to answer all questions	Create dedicated pages for each priority query your audience asks

10 Further Strategic Considerations

The measures in this guide focus on what you can do at page and content level. Beyond that, there are three larger strategic initiatives that amplify GenAI visibility at a structural level. Understanding them helps you see how your local content fits into the bigger picture.

Topic Clustering

What: Instead of creating isolated pages, build interconnected content ecosystems around each priority topic. A topic cluster consists of one primary answer page, several supporting sub-question pages, evidence pages, an FAQ section, and strong internal links between all of them.

Why it matters: AI systems evaluate not just individual pages but how comprehensively a website covers a topic. A well-connected cluster signals deep expertise and makes it more likely that your content gets selected over a competitor's single page.

CI example: *A "hearing preservation" cluster might include: a primary page on whether CI affects natural hearing, supporting pages on residual hearing, electrode design factors, surgical technique, study summaries, a patient FAQ, and a clinician-oriented evidence review — all linked together.*

Information Architecture

What: Designing the overall site structure so that AI systems can efficiently discover, understand, and navigate your most important content. This includes URL hierarchy, site-wide internal linking logic, and the relationship between informational and product content.

Why it matters: If your site structure buries important answers three clicks deep, or mixes educational content with product pages without clear separation, AI crawlers are less likely to find and correctly interpret your best content.

CI example: *Informational pages ("What is a cochlear implant?") should be easily reachable from the homepage and interlinked with evidence and FAQ content — product pages come later in the journey, not as entry points.*

Cross-Market & Cross-Language Alignment

What: Ensuring that the same priority topics are covered with consistent quality, claim language, and evidence depth across all languages and markets — not strong in one language and thin in another.

Why it matters: AI systems serve answers globally. If your English content is evidence-rich and well-structured but your German or Spanish pages are thin translations with no local evidence, you lose visibility in those markets.

CI example: *If the English hearing preservation page includes four inline citations and a study summary, the German equivalent should have comparable depth — adapted for the local clinical context, not just translated.*

> These initiatives are strategic in nature and involve cross-functional coordination. The operational recommendations in this guide are designed to be effective independently — but they become significantly more powerful when embedded in these larger structures.